

CMST 386 Project 2: Website Proposal

Underground Virtual Support

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1. Client and Topic

For my final website project, I will create a website for a home-based business called Underground Virtual Support. This business will provide virtual administrative support services to entrepreneurs, small business owners, and independent professionals who need help with organization, scheduling, email management, documents, and daily office tasks.

2. Development Process and Engagement

I am creating this website for a business idea that I developed myself. Since I am not working with an outside client, I will research similar virtual assistant and administrative support websites to understand what type of information should be included. I will review how these websites explain their services, organize navigation, use calls to action, and present contact information. I will also consider the needs of small business owners who may be looking for affordable and dependable support. This research will help me create content that is clear, useful, and realistic for the target audience.

3. Testing

Before launching the website, I will test each page to make sure the site works as intended. I will click every navigation link to confirm that it opens the correct page. I will also test all images, buttons, and contact information to make sure nothing is broken or missing. I will review the website layout on different screen sizes to make sure the content remains readable and organized. I will test the website in Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, and Mozilla Firefox. I will also ask someone else to review the site and give feedback on whether the navigation is easy to understand and whether the business purpose is clear.

4. Description

Underground Virtual Support is a virtual administrative support business designed to help small business owners, entrepreneurs, and independent professionals stay organized. The goal of the business is to provide dependable support with tasks such as scheduling, email management, document preparation, data entry, customer follow-

up, and general office organization. The business helps clients save time so they can focus on serving customers and growing their business.

The purpose of the website is to promote the business, explain the services offered, build trust with potential clients, and provide a simple way for visitors to make contact. The website should clearly explain what Underground Virtual Support does and why a client would benefit from using the service.

The target audience includes adults who own or manage small businesses, independent professionals, consultants, beauty professionals, online business owners, and entrepreneurs. Many of these users may be between the ages of 25 and 55 and may have limited time to handle administrative tasks. They may access the website from a phone, tablet, laptop, or desktop computer, so the design should be simple, organized, and easy to navigate. The audience may also prefer clear language, quick service descriptions, and easy contact options.

Identifying the target audience will affect how I develop the website because the site needs to look professional, trustworthy, and simple. I will avoid cluttered pages and make the navigation easy to follow. The content will be written in plain language so visitors can quickly understand the services. The website will offer original text created by me, including business descriptions, service explanations, frequently asked questions, and process information. Images may come from royalty-free or properly credited sources, but the written content and layout will be created by me. The website content should be updated as services, pricing, contact information, or business needs change.

5. Growth and Maintenance

The website can continue to grow over time by adding client testimonials, blog posts, new service pages, pricing updates, and examples of administrative support packages. While developing the website, I can make it easier to maintain by using a consistent layout, organized folders, clear file names, reusable navigation, and one external CSS file for styling. Maintenance tasks will include checking links, updating service details, reviewing contact information, replacing outdated images, and testing the website after changes. Contact information should be checked monthly. Links and images should be tested monthly. Service descriptions and pricing should be reviewed every few months or whenever the business changes.

6. Organization

The website content will be organized around the main services offered by Underground Virtual Support. The site will include ten pages: Home, About, Services, Scheduling Support, Email Management, Document Preparation, Data Entry, Client Process, FAQ,

and Contact. This structure gives visitors a clear path to learn about the business, understand the services, review how the process works, and contact the business.

The Home page will introduce the business and include a short summary of the main services. The About page will explain the purpose and values of Underground Virtual Support. The Services page will provide an overview of all services. Individual service pages will give more details about scheduling support, email management, document preparation, and data entry. The Client Process page will explain how a new client can get started. The FAQ page will answer common questions. The Contact page will provide contact information and a simple contact form or contact instructions.

The navigation will appear at the top of each page and will include links to the main pages. The layout will use a consistent header, navigation menu, main content area, and footer. The design will use a professional color scheme, readable fonts, clear headings, and organized sections.

7. Security

The website will not include an e-commerce component because Underground Virtual Support will not sell products directly through the site. The website will also not require users to create accounts because the main purpose is to provide information and allow potential clients to make contact. No content will be password protected because the website is designed for public business promotion.

As a website designer and developer, I can help secure the website by using safe file management practices, keeping file names organized, avoiding unnecessary scripts, validating forms, and not collecting sensitive personal information through the site. If a contact form is used, it should only request basic information such as name, email, and message. The website should also use HTTPS through the web host so visitors can access it securely.

8. Web Hosting

When selecting a web host, I would consider reliability, cost, security features, customer support, storage, bandwidth, ease of use, and whether the host supports the technologies needed for the website. I would also review whether the host provides SSL certificates, regular backups, uptime guarantees, and a simple control panel for managing website files.

The website will need SSL because visitors should be able to access the site using HTTPS. Since the website is mostly informational, it will not need a shopping cart or advanced e-commerce tools. The site will need support for HTML5, CSS3, and possibly JavaScript if interactive features are added later, such as a contact form or simple menu

effects. If a working contact form is added in the future, the host may need to support server-side scripting or a third-party form service.

A possible domain name for the website is:

undergroundvirtualsupport.com

This domain name works because it matches the business name and clearly describes the service. It is professional, easy to remember, and includes keywords related to virtual support. If that domain is not available, another possible option would be:

uvsupportservices.com

This shorter version is also easy to remember and still connects to the business name and services.

9. Marketing

The website will be marketed through search engine optimization, social media, business directories, networking, and direct sharing with small business owners. SEO will be important because potential clients may search for services such as virtual assistant, administrative support, email management, scheduling support, and small business support.

SEO elements that can be included during the website planning and building process include descriptive title tags, relevant meta descriptions, keyword-focused page content, proper heading hierarchy, meaningful link text, alternative image text, and clear page names. Each service page can focus on a specific keyword or service. The website can also use professional content that answers common questions potential clients may have before contacting the business.

10. Project Reflection

To complete the wireframes, I used Microsoft PowerPoint because it was simple to create boxes, labels, and a basic page layout. PowerPoint made it easier to move sections around and visually plan the structure of the website before building it. I created the homepage wireframe, interior page wireframe, and sitemap in PowerPoint, then included them in the final proposal PDF.

When building the flowchart diagram, I learned that website organization needs to be planned before the pages are created. The sitemap helped me understand how the pages connect to each other and how the navigation should work. It also helped me see that the Services page should connect to the individual service pages, such as Scheduling Support, Email Management, Document Preparation, and Data Entry.

I did not use one of the listed diagramming applications because PowerPoint was easier for me to use and was enough to create simple wireframes and a sitemap. The main challenge in developing the navigation was deciding how to include ten pages without making the menu confusing. I resolved this by grouping the service-related pages under the general Services section and keeping the main navigation focused on the most important pages.

Someone new to creating web pages might struggle with planning the number of pages, organizing content, and understanding how navigation affects the user experience. They may also struggle with deciding what content belongs on each page. Creating the proposal first makes the final website easier to build because the topic, audience, pages, layout, and purpose are already planned before coding begins.

Planned Website Pages

1. Home
2. About
3. Services
4. Scheduling Support
5. Email Management
6. Document Preparation
7. Data Entry
8. Client Process
9. FAQ
10. Contact

Home Page Wireframe

Header: Underground Virtual Support
Navigation: Home About Services Process FAQ Contact
Hero Section Helping Small Businesses Stay Organized Short intro + Contact Button
Service Preview Scheduling Email Management Document Preparation Data Entry
Why Choose Us Reliable Organized Flexible Professional
Footer

Interior Page Wireframe: Email Management

Header: Underground Virtual Support
Navigation: Home About Services Process FAQ Contact
Page Title: Email Management
Service Description Short paragraph explaining email management support
What Is Included - Inbox organization - Message sorting - Follow-up reminders - Client communication support
Call to Action: Contact Us
Footer

Website Sitemap

